

B.C. Child Care Sector Occupational Competencies

Assessment Tool



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Introduction

This assessment tool has been developed to help people use the B.C. Child Care Sector Occupational Competencies in different ways. These include self-assessment by early childhood educators (practitioners), evaluation of staff by employers, identification of professional development needs, development of curriculum, evaluation of students, especially in practicum settings and a checklist for accreditation purposes.

The assessment tool has been organized into two sections: knowledge and activities. The knowledge section is a checklist of a practitioner's understanding of professional requirements. The longer activities section, divided into eight main "functional areas," lists the activities that are performed in practice. Used together, the knowledge and activities sections will provide information needed to track and enhance skills and performance.

Using the assessment tool to assess competence

In the activities section, this tool does two things: it describes areas of functional competence and provides a way to rate competency levels in those areas. The tool's matrix describes the areas of competence, while a unique rating scale allows people to assess competency levels.

Using the activities section is a two-step process. First, the expected competency level for each activity is rated, using professional objectives, a job description or curriculum. Remember: different jobs or situations have different expectations. In some cases, an activity may not be required, in others, a competency level of 2 or 3 is necessary. In rare cases only, a rating of 5 meets the required standards. The competency rating scale is provided below:

Competency rating scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

For your information, the Appendices section of this document provides the required competency levels for post-secondary early childhood education and B.C. early childhood educator certification, as well as the Linking Competencies. The Linking Competencies complement the

B.C. Child Care Sector Occupational Competencies by organizing the occupational standards for basic and post-basic programs into required minimum areas of instruction and hours.

The second step in this process is to measure the actual level of competency of the practitioner, student or employee. This involves going through the tool a second time, rating the individual's competency. After this step is completed, there is a numerical comparison between the expectations and actual situation. It is then possible to identify areas of strength and areas where further efforts are needed.

When you use this tool, remember that:

- We do not work in ideal environments and situations – keep your reality in mind and respect the work that you do well!
- Child care and education vary greatly around B.C. Try to see your work in the context of your own community, and complete assessments with your community's unique identity in mind
- Reflective analysis is the key to using the tool in a meaningful way
- You do not have to go through the entire tool at one time. You might instead decide to tackle one area at a time
- However you use the tool, think of examples that support your own level of competence, or the level of competence of your employees or students
- Use this tool more than once – only through comparison with earlier assessments will you see how growth and improvement have occurred

Knowledge Specifications

A. Understanding

A-1 Child growth and development

Child growth and development is the heart of the work in this sector. Practitioners need to understand child growth and development from birth to 12 years of age across all developmental domains. The critical concepts are:

- ☐ Range of historic and current theoretical approaches to child growth and development from a cross-cultural perspective
- ☐ Child growth and development as part of on-going life span development
- ☐ Growth and development in key developmental domains including social/emotional, physical, cognitive, language and cultural
- ☐ Holistic and interdependent nature of growth and development
- ☐ Stages and milestones in the developmental process
- ☐ Individual variations in the developmental process
- ☐ Role of individual temperament, abilities, learning and communication styles in the developmental process
- ☐ Indicators of the developmental delays or concerns and associated risks
- ☐ Personal perspective on child growth and development to guide practice

A-2 Children's rights

Understanding and respecting children's rights is an essential part of good practice. Practitioners need to understand the concept of inherent rights and the relationship between rights and responsibilities. The critical concepts are:

- ☐ Children's right to protection from abuse, neglect and exploitation
- ☐ Children's right to the provision of high-quality inclusive services that honour diversity
- ☐ Children's right to participate in decisions that affect them to their maximum developmental capacity

A-3 Professional accountability and ethics

Practitioners need to understand the high level of professional accountability and ethical behaviour that is required in the sector. The critical concepts are:

- ☐ Early Childhood Educators of BC Code of Ethics and ethical decision-making and judgement
- ☐ Relevant legal and/or contractual obligations that guide practice
- ☐ Appropriate professional boundaries
- ☐ Impact of personal values and philosophy on practice

A-4 Systems

It is critical that practitioners understand that children and families are part of systems. Services are developed and operated within systems and child care is part of the larger community social service system. The ability to understand systems and to think systematically is an essential part of best practice. The critical concepts are:

- ☐ Basic systems theory
- ☐ Key components of systems including structure, function, subsystems and boundaries
- ☐ Nature of open and closed systems
- ☐ Effect of change within systems
- ☐ Impact of power and power imbalances within systems

It is also critical that practitioners understand:

- ☐ Family systems
- ☐ Child care system
- ☐ Community social service system
- ☐ Educational system

B. Ability

B-1 Communicate effectively

Effective communication is an essential part of good practice. Practitioners need to understand basic communication theory and have well-developed receptive and responsive communication skills. It is critical that practitioners are able to:

- ☐ Use verbal, non-verbal, written and, when necessary, alternative communication methods appropriately and effectively
- ☐ Recognize and respond appropriately to a wide range of individual communication styles
- ☐ Communicate across cultures and, when possible, in more than one language

- ☐ Participate in groups to make decisions, solve problems and resolve conflicts

B-2 Honour diversity

The ability to honour and affirm diversity is an essential part of good practice. Practitioners need to understand and be comfortable with a wide range of diverse life experiences. It is critical that practitioners are able to:

- ☐ Clarify own biases
- ☐ Demonstrate cultural competence
- ☐ Implement anti-bias strategies
- ☐ Promote inclusion

B-3 Observe, document, assess, plan, implement and evaluate

The ability to consistently engage in the process of observation, documentation, assessment, planning, implementation and evaluation is an essential part of best practice. This interrelated set of skills ensures that all practice has a clear purpose. It is critical that practitioners are able to:

- ☐ Observe in unbiased and non-judgmental ways
- ☐ Document observations in clear language and through other accessible methods
- ☐ Plan appropriate programs, responses and interventions
- ☐ Organize and facilitate the implementation of the plan
- ☐ Evaluate the effectiveness and/or outcomes and make necessary adaptations

B-4 Build relationships

The ability to form caring relationships that are based on genuineness, respect and empathy is an essential part of best practice. It is critical that practitioners are able to:

- ☐ Attend, engage, listen actively, reflect, challenge and self-disclose appropriately
- ☐ Show appreciation for, and enjoyment of others
- ☐ Be patient and flexible

B-5 Reflect on, and improve, personal and professional practice

The ability to continually reflect and improve on practice is an essential part of best practice. Practitioners need to understand the impact of their values, beliefs, attitudes and behaviour on children, families and communities. It is critical that practitioners are able to:

- ☐ Clarify and articulate personal values and philosophy of practice

- ☐ Assess their own strengths and weaknesses
- ☐ Give and receive constructive criticism
- ☐ Recognize and accept personal limits
- ☐ Care for themselves
- ☐ Be open to growth and change

C. Knowledge

C-1 Community

It is critical that practitioners have current information about the community in which they work. They need to know:

- ☐ Socio-economic characteristics of the community
- ☐ Cultural composition of the community
- ☐ Other community services, resources and supports available in the community
- ☐ Other child care services in the community

Practitioners also need to know where they can find current data about:

- ☐ Structure and needs of families in the community
- ☐ Significant changes in the community
- ☐ Significant development plans for the community

C-2 Regulatory framework

It is critical that practitioners have current information about the regulatory framework within which child care services operate. They need to know:

- ☐ Governmental mandates and jurisdictions
- ☐ Current licensing and/or registration(certification) regulations
- ☐ Organizational structure, authority and procedures for provincial and local Community Care Facilities licensing
- ☐ Current Child, Family and Community Service Act including the duty to report neglect or abuse and reporting protocols
- ☐ Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act and corresponding regulations

C-3 Child care service

It is critical that practitioners know the following information about the organization and/or service where they are employed:

- ☐ Organizational structure
- ☐ Decision-making protocols and procedures
- ☐ Mandate, vision and/or philosophy
- ☐ Policies and procedures governing their work
- ☐ Job description and responsibilities
- ☐ Key or target constituency served

Values and Ethics

Early Childhood Educators of BC Code of Ethics

- ☐ Promote the health and well-being of all children
- ☐ Provide high-quality early care and learning environments for all children by drawing on specialized knowledge, education, and diverse perspectives
- ☐ Demonstrate caring and compassion for all children through responsive and reciprocal relationships
- ☐ Work in partnership with families, supporting them in meeting their responsibilities for their children
- ☐ Establish and maintain respectful partnerships with colleagues, allied professionals, community partners, and decision-makers to support the well-being of children and their families
- ☐ Work in ways that affirm and enhance human dignity, respect fundamental human rights, and celebrate difference and diversity
- ☐ Maintain the knowledge, skills, and self-awareness needed to be professionally competent
- ☐ Prioritize our personal health and well-being
- ☐ Demonstrate integrity and respect in our professional relationships
- ☐ Advocate that our profession is vital to establishing healthy and resilient communities

Activities

Function No. 1: Create and maintain a safe and healthy environment for children

1-a	Ensure that the environment complies with or exceeds licensing requirements and/or report licensing related issues appropriately		Required level	Level attained
	1-a-1(a)	Conduct safety checks of grounds, facilities, furnishings, equipment and materials		
	1-a-1(b)	Identify unsafe items for removal, replacement or repair		
	1-a-2	Maintain compliance with provincial licensing regulations (e.g., staff-child ratios)		
	1-a-3	Demonstrate up-to-date knowledge of current licensing regulations and requirements		
	1-a-4	Comply with current legislative and regulatory requirements (e.g. Criminal Record Check, nutrition)		
	1-a-5	Explain the importance of current licensing regulations for staff, families, volunteers, others		
	1-a-6	Report licensing related issues promptly and appropriately		
	1-a-7	Maintain regular and on-going communication with licensing officers within established protocols		

1-b	Develop, implement and maintain policies that ensure the health and safety of all children		Required level	Level attained
	1-b-1	Monitor, record and update children's physical and emotional health status using appropriate methods		
	1-b-2	Plan nutritious, appealing, and balanced snacks and meals, taking into account cultural preferences		
	1-b-3(a)	Demonstrate up-to-date knowledge of illness and injury prevention strategies that ensure health and safety (e.g., sleeping positions and SIDS)		
	1-b-3(b)	Develop, implement and maintain comprehensive policies and procedures about sick and injured children and those with other health care needs (i.e., allergies, diets)		
	1-b-4(a)	Develop, implement and maintain comprehensive policies and procedures for storing and administering medication		
	1-b-4(b)	Store and administer medication		

	1-b-5	Supervise children at all times and maintain an awareness of the whole group when working with an individual child or small group		
	1-b-6	Demonstrate a knowledge and practice of required hygiene standards and procedures		
	1-b-7	Practice Universal Precautions for all personal care activities		
	1-b-8	Develop, implement and maintain emergency procedures and protocols, including those for fire, earthquake and critical incidents		
	1-b-9	Develop, implement and maintain policies and procedures for obtaining and recording the appropriate legal guardian's consent for all necessary activities		

1-c	Design environments that meet the development and educational needs of children and ensure their health, safety and well-being		Required level	Level attained
	1-c-1	Provide children with access to a range of activity areas that promote small and large motor, cognitive, creative, language and social/emotional development		
	1-c-2	Create play environments that reflect the diversity within the community and maximize interaction and exploration		
	1-c-3	Create play environments that are appropriate and enable participation by children with a range of physical abilities		
	1-c-4	Select indoor and outdoor furniture, equipment and materials that are developmentally appropriate in size and function		
	1-c-5	Provide children with access to space for individual, small and large group activities		
	1-c-6	Use colour, lighting, noise control and visual stimulation appropriately throughout the environment to enhance and promote a full range of activities		
	1-c-7	Access appropriate resources and materials for children and staff		

1-d	Comply with child protection responsibilities as outlined in legislation, regulations, protocols and court orders		Required level	Level attained
	1-d-1(a)	Develop, implement and maintain policies, protocols and procedures for reporting protection concerns and/or complying with court orders		
	1-d-1(b)	Report protection concerns and/or comply with court orders		

	1-d-2	Explain policies, protocols and procedures for reporting protection concerns and/or complying with court orders to families who are encouraged to seek clarification		
	1-d-3(a)	Maintain accurate and current records about child protection and/or custody issues as required by statutory and regulatory requirements		
	1-d-3(b)	Maintain confidentiality		
	1-d-4	Observe, monitor and report on potential risks or indicators of abuse and neglect		
	1-d-5	Develop, implement and maintain policies and procedures for ensuring the personal safety of staff		
	1-d-6	Respond to allegations of misconduct by staff or others working within the program		

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0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
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2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
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4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Function No. 2: Plan and implement developmentally appropriate programs that meet the observed needs of children

2-a	Plan and implement comprehensive programs that promote each child's social, emotional, cognitive, physical, communicative and cultural development		Required level	Level attained
	2-a-1	Observe, monitor and record each child's developmental progress		
	2-a-2	Ensure that programming is informed by knowledge of each child's unique needs, stage of development, and learning style		
	2-a-3	Provide a wide range of stimulating and challenging play-based activities that foster the development of the whole child		
	2-a-4	Demonstrate use of a variety of teaching methods to enhance children's development and learning		

	2-a-5	Provide programming that ensures an appropriate balance of child-initiated, adult-guided, structured, and open-ended activities		
	2-a-6	Provide children with opportunities to participate in individual, small and large group activities		
	2-a-7	Develop, implement and maintain programming that is culturally appropriate and affirming		
	2-a-8	Ensure programming is consistent with the service's philosophy and policies		
	2-a-9	Share responsibility for program planning, evaluation and implementation amongst all staff members		
	2-a-10	Identify and act on opportunities to improve programming based on self-reflection, current research and emerging trends that reflect good practice		

2-b	Plan and implement a wide range of stimulating and challenging play-based activities that foster the development of the whole child		Required level	Level attained
	2-b-1	Observe, monitor and record each child's developmental progress in non-judgmental and objective ways		
	2-b-2	Design comprehensive ¹ programs that promote each child's social, emotional, cognitive, physical, communicative, and cultural development		
	2-b-3	Plan and implement routines that provide for extended periods of play		
	2-b-4	Prepare program activities that acknowledge and reflect each child's developmental level and learning style		
	2-b-5	Provide each child with the opportunity to participate in individual, small and large group activities		

2-c	Ensure that program and services reflect and respect diversity		Required level	Level attained
	2-c-1	Reflect a consistent anti-bias approach and honour diversity in service philosophy, policies, and procedures		
	2-c-2	Create an environment and activities that are culturally affirming and relevant to all groups		
	2-c-3	Encourage families to share their cultural beliefs and child rearing practices		

¹ Refers to a balance of learning opportunities including: language, literature, music, movement, art, science, math, community awareness and social responsibility.

	2-c-4	Demonstrate respect for each family's home language and use when appropriate and/or necessary as resources are available		
	2-c-5	Integrate children's cultural celebrations, practices and cuisine into program activities		
	2-c-6	Reflect and clarify own values and biases in a mutually respectful climate with staff		
	2-c-7	Resolve issues or conflicts arising from diverse perspectives and experiences		

2-d	Provide and/or access the supports that are required for the successful inclusion of each child		Required level	Level attained
	2-d-1	Develop service philosophies, policies and procedures that are inclusive		
	2-d-2	Create an environment that is safe, accessible and welcoming for each child and family		
	2-d-3	Develop, implement and maintain a coordinated, individual plan in collaboration with families, caregivers and other relevant service providers for the successful inclusion of each child		
	2-d-4	Develop, implement and maintain many strategies for informing all families about the benefits of inclusion		
	2-d-5	Facilitate networking opportunities for families		
	2-d-6	Maintain cooperative, on-going communication with other services for families and children who require additional support		
	2-d-7	Use specialized equipment, adaptations and materials as needed and/or prescribed		

2-e	Communicate with families about their child's growth and development		Required level	Level attained
	2-e-1	Listen and respond to each family's views in a manner that supports and respects the individual family		
	2-e-2	Employ a variety of strategies to communicate with families about their child's progress in ways that meet each family's needs and preferences		
	2-e-3	Develop and maintain a consistent relationship with each family		
	2-e-4	Communicate with families through a variety of creative and respectful methods		
	2-e-5	Maintain confidentiality in all verbal and written communications with, and about, families in keeping with legislative, professional and organizational requirements		

Competency Rating Scale	
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1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Function No. 3: Nurture children to promote positive development

3-a	Establish an emotionally safe and nurturing climate		Required level	Level attained
	3-a-1	Develop positive approaches to guide children's behaviour		
	3-a-2	Guide children's behaviour using a range of developmentally appropriate, consistent and positive approaches		
	3-a-3	Encourage children to openly express their positive and negative feelings through a range of verbal, non-verbal and culturally based communication styles		
	3-a-4	Consult with parents and other professionals in cases where high level intervention strategies are used		

3-b	Establish genuine and trusting relationships with children and others		Required level	Level attained
	3-b-1	Acknowledge and respond to each child's behaviours, interests and ideas		
	3-b-2	Communicate with each child in a style, manner, and at a pace and level that is appropriate to their needs		
	3-b-3	Use supportive and positive language and congruent verbal and non-verbal messages in communication with children		
	3-b-4	Encourage consistent relationships between children and caregivers		
	3-b-5	Share information about each child with other caregivers using discretion and respect		
	3-b-6	Share responsibility for the care of children with other relevant team members		

3-c	Enable children to develop self-esteem		Required level	Level attained
	3-c-1	Offer a range of activities that allows each child to achieve success		

	3-c-2	Respond positively to children's efforts to learn, grow and acquire new skills		
	3-c-3	Provide opportunities for the development of social skills and attitudes that help children become participating members of groups and communities		
	3-c-4	Encourage children to share their ideas and feelings with their peers		
	3-c-5	Support children to make decisions and solve problems (as is developmentally appropriate)		
	3-c-6	Provide families with positive feedback about their children's development and the importance of self-esteem		
	3-c-7	Encourage and support positive personal self-esteem for all staff members		

Competency Rating Scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Function No. 4: Support families

4-a	Demonstrate a knowledge of, and respect for, cultural, socio-economic and family diversity in all aspects of care		Required level	Level attained
	4-a-1	Develop service philosophy, policies and procedures that respect and reflect family diversity and describe the primary role of families in the care of their children		
	4-a-2	Listen to families attentively and encourage them to express their needs		
	4-a-3	Acknowledge individual parenting practices in a respectful manner		
	4-a-4	Offer families a range of strategies and suggestions to augment their parenting skills		
	4-a-5	Provide program activities and materials that respect and reflect a full range of family structures and lifestyles		
	4-a-6	Provide program activities that support and enhance families' capacity to provide their children with enriching and stimulating experiences		

	4-a-7	Welcome and involve other significant people in children's lives		
	4-a-8	Respond respectfully to families' needs for resources (e.g., books, extra clothing and bedding, field trip fees, access to laundry facilities)		
	4-a-9	Identify, research and share information about community resources that respond to family diversity		

4-b	Provide information about child care and other related resource and referral services to families		Required level	Level attained
	4-b-1	Help families access child care information, and community resource and referral services		
	4-b-2	Respond promptly to requests for information and resources		
	4-b-3	Maintain confidentiality of inquiries and records in keeping with legislative, professional and organizational requirements		
	4-b-4	Offer current and accessible information to families through a variety of methods		

4-c	Promote family involvement in policy and programming decisions		Required level	Level attained
	4-c-1	Provide families with accessible information to clarify service philosophy, policies, procedures		
	4-c-2	Provide families with opportunities to participate in decision-making through a variety of user-friendly and supportive methods		
	4-c-3	Adapt programs regularly in response to expressed family needs		
	4-c-4	Respond promptly to family input and feedback		
	4-c-5	Encourage families to observe, visit and participate in the program		
	4-c-6	Provide families with opportunities for support and networking with each other		

Competency Rating Scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others

n/a	Not expected to perform this function
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Function No. 5: Share information appropriately, cooperate and coordinate efforts with other community services

5-a	Establish and maintain coordinated working relationships with other professionals and service providers involved with a child and/or family		Required level	Level attained
	5-a-1	Develop, maintain and share accurate, current and complete information about community services and resources		
	5-a-2	Contribute to inter-agency and community development activities		
	5-a-3	Provide other service providers with current information about child care services		
	5-a-4	Share resources with other agencies to support their work		

5-b	Contribute to the development of coordinated community, family and individual service plans		Required level	Level attained
	5-b-1	Record and maintain children's and families' records in an accurate, objective and respectful way from initial contact		
	5-b-2	Share information about children and families respectfully and confidentially, as required by legislative, regulatory and policy requirements		
	5-b-3	Develop and implement individual service plans with the full and active participation of family members, their advocates and other relevant agencies		
	5-b-4	Provide referrals to a wide variety of community services		
	5-b-5	Support families in their initial and on-going contact with other agencies and services		
	5-b-6	Advocate on behalf of, and with, children and their families		

Competency Rating Scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Function No. 6: Develop yourself and contribute to the development of others to meet current and future needs

6-a	Plan and implement personal and professional development		Required level	Level attained
	6-a-1	Reflect on and evaluate professional practice on an on-going basis using an established, professional child care code of ethics		
	6-a-2	Develop and implement a personal professional development plan, identifying achievable, realistic and appropriate short and long-term goals		
	6-a-3	Invite input and assessment by colleagues/others		
	6-a-4	Recognize and include personal wellness as a component of a personal professional development plan		
	6-a-5	Review and revise a personal professional development plan		

6-b	Recognize and respond to changes in public social policy that affect children, families, services and communities		Required level	Level attained
	6-b-1	Acknowledge and respond to emerging issues that affect children, families, organizations and/or communities		
	6-b-2	Contribute to the identification and resolution of public policy issues that affect the child care profession		

6-c	Contribute to the personal and professional development of others		Required level	Level attained
	6-c-1	Contribute to, and participate in, professional and other child care related organizations		
	6-c-2	Share personal/professional development experiences with colleagues in an open and respectful manner		
	6-c-3	Model good practice ² with colleagues, students and volunteers		
	6-c-4	Participate in developing and delivering quality, accessible and affordable professional development resources and activities		
	6-c-5	Provide appropriate orientation, support, guidance, supervision and interpretation of practice to students		

Competency Rating Scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision

² Level of competence required of a certified early childhood educator in B.C. (For the purposes of assessment only, the term “good” is used to describe the level of competence, as there is no one “best” method of practice.)

2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Function No. 7: Contribute to the effective management and administration of child care services

7-a	Participate in the development and implementation of policies and procedures for all aspects of service administration and management		Required level	Level attained
7-a-1	Explain the mandate and philosophy of service and ensure that it is used to guide good practice			
7-a-2	Explain and implement decision-making and governance ³ policies and procedures			
7-a-3	Explain and implement financial management policies and procedures			
7-a-4	Explain and implement human resource management policies and procedures			
7-a-5	Explain and implement record keeping and information sharing systems			

7-b	Contribute to an effective team ⁴ to ensure the delivery of quality child care services		Required level	Level attained
7-b-1	Demonstrate an understanding of the role of the team in developing and/or promoting changes in service philosophy, policies and procedures to improve the quality of service			
7-b-2	Share responsibility with the team for consistent implementation of service philosophy, policies and procedures to guide practice			
7-b-3	Work within the expectations and guidelines established in job descriptions, policies, procedures and codes of conduct			
7-b-4	Demonstrate a knowledge of, and an ability to use, appropriate decision-making processes, including consensus building and conflict resolution			

³ Processes that dictate how a service is operated (i.e., mission statement, goals and objectives, policies, procedures, operations manual).

⁴ Team may include staff, board members, parents, volunteers, etc.

	7-b-5	Contribute to a work environment where individual differences, strengths and weaknesses are acknowledged and respected		
	7-b-6	Participate in the development and implementation of organizational planning		
	7-b-7	Demonstrate an understanding of the importance of diversity in the team		
	7-b-8	Develop, implement and maintain support for the health and well-being of the team		

7-c	Implement good practice and current government child care related policies, programs and procedures		Required level	Level attained
	7-c-1	Meet, and strive to exceed, licensing regulations		
	7-c-2	Develop, implement and maintain strategies to access information about government policies, programs and/or procedures		
	7-c-3	Share information with all stakeholders in an accessible and respectful way		
	7-c-4	Develop and maintain contact with relevant government departments and personnel		
	7-c-5	Share responsibility for assessing the impact of government policies, programs and procedures on good practice		

7-d	Contribute to monitoring and evaluating all aspects of service to maximize effectiveness		Required level	Level attained
	7-d-1	Use a range of evaluative strategies to monitor the effectiveness and quality of service		
	7-d-2	Seek and use families' input in program review processes		
	7-d-3	Adapt services, systems, programming and procedures based on the results of the program review processes		
	7-d-4	Share responsibility with stakeholders for monitoring and evaluating contractual and governance requirements		

Competency Rating Scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Function No. 8: Advocate for a high quality, accessible and comprehensive child care system

8-a	Contribute to the development of a comprehensive range of accessible child care services and supports to meet current and anticipated needs		Required level	Level attained
	8-a-1	Conduct service-based needs assessments regularly		
	8-a-2	Participate in community needs assessments with other agencies to identify gaps and plan for improved service delivery		
	8-a-3	Recommend changes to the appropriate decision-makers		
	8-a-4	Lobby for the resources required for new services, additional supports, and/or changes to existing services		

8-b	Communicate with, and lobby, members of the public, government and other decision-makers about child care and related social issues		Required level	Level attained
	8-b-1	Identify, discuss and analyze related issues that have an impact on children, families and communities		
	8-b-2	Develop recommendations for progressive child care policies in partnership with families, child care organizations and others, as appropriate		
	8-b-3	Use a range of appropriate strategies that meet the needs of specific audiences to advocate for progressive child care policies and resources		
	8-b-4	Educate the public about child care and related issues through a variety of accessible, creative and effective mechanisms		
	8-b-5	Participate in, and support, organizations and groups that are advocating for the well-being of children and families		

Competency Rating Scale	
0	Cannot perform this function sufficiently, with or without assistance
1	Can perform some parts of this function competently with assistance and/or supervision
2	Can perform this function competently with periodic assistance, supervision, and/or referral to resources
3	Can perform this function competently without assistance and/or supervision
4	Can perform this function competently with initiative and adaptability
5	Can perform this function competently and can lead others
n/a	Not expected to perform this function

Appendices

B.C. Child Care Sector Occupational Competencies Required Levels – Post-Secondary and B.C. ECE Certification

Activity	Post-secondary	B.C. ECE Certification
1-a-1(a)	2	3
1-a-1(b)	3	3
1-a-2	2	3
1-a-3	2	3
1-a-4	3	3
1-a-5	2	3
1-a-6	3	3
1-a-7	n/a	3
1-b-1	2	3
1-b-2	2	3
1-b-3	1	3
1-b-4(a)	1	3
1-b-4(b)	3	3
1-b-5	3	3
1-b-6	5	5
1-b-7	5	5
1-b-8	3	3
1-b-9	1	3
1-c-1	2	3
1-c-2	2	3
1-c-3	2	3
1-c-4	2	3
1-c-5	2	3

Activity	Post-secondary	B.C. ECE Certification
2-c-5	2	3
2-c-6	3	3
2-c-7	2	3
2-d-1	1	3
2-d-2	3	4
2-d-3	1	3
2-d-4	1	3
2-d-5	2	3
2-d-6	1	3
2-d-7	1	4
2-e-1	2	3
2-e-2	2	3
2-e-3	2	3
2-e-4	2	3
2-e-5	3	5
3-a-1	3	4
3-a-2	3	4
3-a-3	3	4
3-a-4	1	4
3-b-1	4	4
3-b-2	4	4
3-b-3	4	4
3-b-4	3	4

Activity	Post-secondary	B.C. ECE Certification
5-a-2	1	3
5-a-3	2	3
5-a-4	2	3
5-b-1	2	3
5-b-2	2	4
5-b-3	1	3
5-b-4	1	3
5-b-5	1	3
5-b-6	2	4
6-a-1	2	3
6-a-2	1	3
6-a-3	3	3
6-a-4	2	4
6-a-5	2	3
6-b-1	1	2
6-b-2	1	2
6-c-1	3	4
6-c-2	3	4
6-c-3	2	4
6-c-4	1	3
6-c-5	1	3
7-a-1	1	3
7-a-2	1	2

1-c-6	2	3
1-c-7	2	3
1-d-1(a)	1	3
1-d-1(b)	3	3
1-d-2	2	3
1-d-3(a)	1	3
1-d-3(b)	5	5
1-d-4	4	4
1-d-5	1	3
1-d-6	1	3
2-a-1	3	3
2-a-2	3	3
2-a-3	3	3
2-a-4	3	3
2-a-5	3	3
2-a-6	3	3
2-a-7	3	3
2-a-8	3	3
2-a-9	3	3
2-a-10	3	3
2-b-1	3	3
2-b-2	3	3
2-b-3	3	3
2-b-4	3	3
2-b-5	3	3
2-c-1	3	3
2-c-2	2	3
2-c-3	2	3
2-c-4	3	3

3-b-5	3	4
3-b-6	3	4
3-c-1	3	4
3-c-2	3	4
3-c-3	3	4
3-c-4	3	4
3-c-5	3	4
3-c-6	2	4
3-c-7	3	3
4-a-1	1	3
4-a-2	3	4
4-a-3	3	4
4-a-4	2	3
4-a-5	2	4
4-a-6	2	3
4-a-7	3	5
4-a-8	3	4
4-a-9	2	3
4-b-1	2	3
4-b-2	2	5
4-b-3	3	5
4-b-4	2	3
4-c-1	3	3
4-c-2	2	4
4-c-3	2	4
4-c-4	3	4
4-c-5	4	4
4-c-6	2	4
5-a-1	2	3

7-a-3	1	2
7-a-4	1	2
7-a-5	1	2
7-b-1	3	3
7-b-2	2	3
7-b-3	3	3
7-b-4	1	3
7-b-5	3	4
7-b-6	2	3
7-b-7	3	3
7-b-8	2	4
7-c-1	2	3
7-c-2	2	3
7-c-3	3	4
7-c-4	2	4
7-c-5	2	3
7-d-1	1	3
7-d-2	2	3
7-d-3	1	3
7-d-4	2	3
8-a-1	1	3
8-a-2	2	3
8-a-3	2	3
8-a-4	1	3
8-b-1	2	2
8-b-2	2	3
8-b-3	1	2
8-b-4	2	3
8-b-5	3	3

Linking Competencies – Table 1: Early Childhood Educator

Required Areas of Instruction	Knowledge Areas (K) & Activities (A)
Child Growth and Development (min. 90 hrs): - range of historic and current theoretical approaches to child growth and development - child growth and development as part of on-going life-span development - growth and development in key developmental domains including social/emotional, physical, cognitive, language - genetic and environmental factors which influence individual growth and development - indicators of developmental delays or concerns and associated risks	K A-1, A-2, A-4, B-2, B-3 A Functions 2-a-1, 2-b-1
Program Development, Curriculum and Foundations (min. 312 hrs): - history, foundation and philosophies of early childhood education - planning, implementing and evaluating a developmentally appropriate program that meets the observed needs of children - planning indoor and outdoor play environments that meet the developmental needs of children and ensures their health, safety and well-being - planning and implementing a range of activities including art, music, movement, dramatic play, language, literature, science, social and math experiences that foster the development of the whole child - planning programs that reflect and respect diversity - relationship of environment and development on children's behaviour - development of positive approaches to guide children's behaviour - caring skills and techniques which support and enable children to develop self-esteem	K A-1, A-2, A-3, B-1, B-2, B-3, B-4, C-1, C-2 A Functions 1-c, 2-a, 2-b, 2-c, 2-d, 3-a, 3-b, 3-c, 4-a, 4-c, 5-b, 7-c
Interpersonal Skills/Community Relations/ Families (min. 45 hrs): - professional communication skills (verbal and written) which are mutually supportive of co-workers, families and communities - knowledge of and respect for cultural, socioeconomic and family diversity - community support systems for children and families - promoting family involvement in policy and programming decisions - professional growth, attitude and conduct, including professional development, Code of Ethics, ability to advocate	K A-2, A-3, A-4, B-1, B-2, B-4, B-5, C-1, C-2, C-3 A Functions 2-e, 4-a, 4-b, 4-c, 5-a, 5-b, 6, 7, 8
Health, Safety and Nutrition (30 hrs): - creating and maintaining a safe and healthy environment for children - creating and maintaining policies that ensure health and safety - knowledge and practice of universal precautions, hygiene standards and procedures - planning, preparing and serving meals and snacks which meet children's nutritional needs - assessing, managing and reporting illness and injuries with a focus on preventative practice - knowledge of licensing requirements for child care and child protection responsibilities as outlined in legislation	K A-1, A-2, A-3 B-3, C-2 A Functions 1-a, 1-b, 1-d, 5-b, 7-c
Practicum (min. 425 hrs): - supervised observation and practice in a variety of early childhood settings - seminar discussions between sponsor educators, students and practicum instructors - opportunities to experience different philosophies of early childhood education - opportunities to implement acquired knowledge and competencies in supportive environment - opportunities to analyze experiences through reflection, self-assessment and feedback	A Functions 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7

Table 2: Infant Toddler Educator

* (certification as an Early Childhood Educator is a required prerequisite)

Required Areas of Instruction	Knowledge Areas (K) & Activities (A) with a focus on infants and toddlers
Child Growth and Development for Infants and Toddlers including: - review of normal development from prenatal to three years of age - focus on both typical and atypical infant toddler development in key developmental domains including social/emotional, physical, cognitive, language - review of current theory and research	K A-1, A-2, A-4, B-2 A Functions 2-a-1, 2-b-1
Working with Infants and Toddlers including: - planning, implementing and evaluating developmentally appropriate programs and routines that nurture and meet the observed needs of infants and toddlers - planning indoor and outdoor play environments that meet the developmental needs of infants and toddlers and ensures their health, safety and well-being - development of positive approaches for guiding, caring and interacting with infants and toddlers	K A-1, A-2, A-3, B-1, B-2, B-3, C-2 A Functions 1-c, 2-a, 2-b, 2-c, 2-d, 3, 4-a, 4-c, 5-b, 7-c
Working with Families including: - increased knowledge of and respect for cultural, socioeconomic and family diversity - information on support systems for children and families and related resource and referral services - planning and facilitating a range of opportunities for family involvement in policy and programming decisions - focus on professional growth, attitude and conduct, including professional development, Code of Ethics, ability to advocate	K A-2, A-3, A-4, B-1, B-2, B-4, B-5, C-1, C-2, C-3 A Functions 2-e, 4-a, 4-b, 4-c, 5-a, 5-b, 6, 7, 8
Health, Safety and Nutrition for Infants and Toddlers including: - creating and maintaining a safe and healthy environment for infants and toddlers - developing, implementing and maintaining policies that ensure health and safety - knowledge and practice of illness and injury prevention strategies specific to infants and toddlers - planning, preparation and serving of meal and snacks which meet the nutritional and safety needs of infants and toddlers - assessing, managing and reporting illness and injuries with a focus on preventative practice	K A-1, A-2, A-3, B-3, C-2 A Functions 1-a, 1-b, 1-c, 1-d, 5-b, 7-c
Administration including: - knowledge of licensing requirements for child care specific to infants and toddlers - management and administration of child care services - development of policies and procedures for all aspects of service administration and management - developing working relationships with other professionals and service providers	K A-2, A-3, A-4, B-1, B-2, B-3, B-4, B-5, C-1, C-2, C-3 A Functions 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
Infant Toddler Practicum including: - supervised observation and practice in a variety of infant toddler settings - seminar discussions between sponsor educators, students and practicum instructors - opportunities to implement acquired knowledge and competencies specific to infants and toddlers - opportunities to analyze experiences through reflection, self-assessment and feedback	A Functions 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8

Table 3: Special Needs Educator

* (certification as an Early Childhood Educator is a required prerequisite)

Required Areas of Instruction	Knowledge Areas (K) & Activities (A) with a focus on children who require support
Child Growth and Development, including: - review of normal and atypical development from prenatal to six years of age - focus on both typical and atypical development in key developmental domains including social/emotional, physical, cognitive, language - review of current theory and research	K A-1, A-2, A-4, B-2, B-3 A Functions 2-a-1, 2-b-1
Working with children who require additional support, including: - planning, implementing and evaluating an inclusive and developmentally appropriate program that meets the observed needs of children who require support - planning accessible, inclusive indoor and outdoor play environments that meet the developmental needs of children who require additional support and ensure health, safety and well-being - development of positive approaches for guiding, caring and interacting with children with challenging behaviour	K A-1, A-2, A-3, B-1, B-2, B-3, C-1, C-2 A Functions 1-c, 2-a, 2-b, 2-c, 2-d, 3, 4-a, 4-c, 5-b, 7-c
Working with Families including: - increased knowledge of and respect for cultural, socioeconomic and family diversity - information on support systems for children and families who require additional support and related resource and referral services - planning and facilitating a range of opportunities for family involvement in policy and programming decisions that support inclusion - focus on professional growth, attitude and conduct, including professional development, Code of Ethics, ability to advocate	K A-2, A-3, A-4, B-1, B-2, B-4, B-5, C-1, C-2, C-3 A Functions 2-e, 4-a, 4-b, 4-c, 5-a, 5-b, 6, 7, 8
Health, Safety and Nutrition for inclusive environments including: - creating and maintaining a safe and healthy environment for children who require additional support - developing, implementing and maintaining policies that ensure health and safety - knowledge and practice of illness and injury prevention standards and procedures that ensure the health, safety and care of all children - assessing, managing and reporting illness and injuries with a focus on preventative practice	K A-1, A-2, A-3, B-3, C-2 A Functions 1-a, 1-b, 1-c, 1-d, 2-d
Administration including: - knowledge of licensing requirements for child care - management and administration of inclusive child care services - development of inclusive philosophies, policies and procedures for all aspects of service administration and management - developing working relationships with other professionals and service providers	K A-2, A-3, A-4, B-1, B-2, B-3, B-4, B-5, C-1, C-2, C-3 A Functions 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
Special Needs Practicum including: - supervised observation and practice in a variety of child care settings which include children who require additional support - seminar discussions between sponsor educators, students and practicum instructors - opportunities to implement acquired knowledge and competencies specific to children who require additional support - opportunities to analyze experiences through reflection, self-assessment and feedback	A Functions 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8